



Welcome to the Integrated Marine Fisheries Lab

I look forward to working with you and getting to know you during your time at OSU!

This document provides some initial guidance for achieving success in your degree or research program. It also outlines my expectations for members of the Integrated Marine Fisheries (IMF) Lab. Most importantly, this document serves as a foundation for effective communication. Please read it carefully and follow up with any questions.

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Please read [OSU's New Graduate Student Guide](#) for more information and resources.

My Mentorship Style

My primary responsibility as a mentor is to train students and early career professionals to conduct high-quality science that has real-world applications. Critical thinking and effective communication are among the most important skills that you can expect to gain under my guidance. I will invest considerable time and energy to help you grow these skills. I also expect that you will take ownership over your own professional development by taking full advantage of the opportunities presented and making the best use of feedback provided (after all, that feedback is evidence of how others have invested in you). I value open and honest communication and will try to be clear about my expectations of you. I also encourage you to help prevent misunderstandings by asking clarifying questions, providing regular progress reports, etc. Please attempt to resolve conflicts in a timely manner and consider the varied needs of the IMF Lab when communicating concerns.

Being Part of the IMF Lab

Although your primary responsibility is to your degree or research program, you are also part of a team. As a member of the IMF Lab, I expect you to help foster a collaborative and supportive environment. This is accomplished by being prepared for and actively engaged in lab meetings, providing thoughtful feedback on the work of others, and maintaining a growth mindset. I will ask for your assistance with various lab-related tasks from time to time. Science (particularly fisheries science) is a collaborative, service-oriented endeavor and should be viewed through that lens.

Please read the [DEI statement](#) created in collaboration with my former advisor and fellow students at the University of Alaska Fairbanks. We strive to reflect these values in the IMF Lab. We will invariably make mistakes. I expect all lab members to consider, learn, and grow from different perspectives.

Meetings and Communications

Regular meetings allow me to stay informed about your work so that I can effectively help you set goals, identify professional development opportunities, troubleshoot issues, and maintain sufficient research progress. These meetings also help build a foundation for trust and effective communication.

Individual Meetings Individual meetings are typically scheduled for 30 min each week. The purpose is to check in about your academic or research progress, outline action items necessary to meet individual or project goals, and provide dedicated time for anything that you would like to discuss. If you require longer or more frequent meetings, please reach out. You are also welcome and encouraged to send emails between regularly scheduled meetings. If you don't hear back in 3 to 5 business days, please resend your message. I have many demands for my time and receive a high volume of communications but always prioritize supporting all members of the IMF Lab.

Mentees are expected to take the lead during individual meetings. Please be prepared by prioritizing a list of topics, sharing materials ahead of time when review is required, taking detailed notes of the discussion, and addressing action items in a timely manner.

Lab Meetings IMF Lab meetings are typically scheduled for 1.5 hr on a biweekly basis each term. During the summer months, we hold weekly 1 hr meetings in order to maximize participation by undergraduate students. Lab meetings are intended to keep everyone connected, foster support among the group, improve your knowledge and capabilities as a scientist, create a platform for soliciting feedback on research materials, and/or troubleshooting issues that may arise.

General Advice for Early Career Scientists

Take advantage of opportunities presented You will be presented with many opportunities for professional development, networking, and other new experiences in marine science. Take advantage of these whenever you can! Some opportunities (e.g., auditing courses, participating in workshops, assisting others with data collection) may be unpaid but will bolster your marketable skills.

Set realistic goals One of the most challenging aspects of science is keeping motivation and focus when there are few near-term deadlines. Setting small, achievable, and timely goals help maintain momentum. They also help generate robust research products. We will work together to outline tractable objectives at various time scales (e.g., annual, academic term, week).

Read and write as much as you can One way to grow as a scientist is by digesting the scientific literature. Source materials that are directly and indirectly related to your work. Identify the different ways that people frame and address research questions. See how your work fits within a broader scientific context. You are not expected to understand everything you read. Your comprehension will grow as you continue to read about what's already been accomplished in our field. Importantly, I encourage you to provide feedback on the written work of others to gain experience with peer review and improve your own writing.

Talk with me about funding Because funding is context-specific, we should have regular conversations about your current funding situation and potential options for future support. Funding is always limited and often publicly-sourced. Thus, we have a responsibility to use those funds wisely. I will look to you for help in reducing costs wherever possible.

Solicit varied perspectives Brainstorming with other students, stakeholders, resource managers, and academics is a great way to gain a fresh take on your research or solve an issue that you've been struggling with. Engage in regular conversations about science and fishery-related issues, solicit formal and informal feedback on your work, and practice communicating the details of your research to varied groups. Much of what we learn comes from these activities. They also help you fine-tune your messaging and increase your confidence as a scientist.

Manage your time Scientific research requires completing deliverables on pre-determined timelines. As a result, there may be times where extended work hours are required to conduct fieldwork, troubleshoot an ongoing issue, or meet nearing deadlines. You will also find that your brain needs down time to process complex information. Thus, it is important to be intentional about taking time off. This means working efficiently on research objectives AND creating space for personal activities. Personal leave must be timed such that it does not conflict with project objectives or meeting deadlines for deliverables.

Build a support system Your time at OSU will provide opportunities for extraordinary growth - both personally and professionally. It is important that you care for your mental and physical health during this brief but challenging time. Creating a network of support (e.g., family, friends, peers, mentors) and engaging with the broader community will help promote your overall well-being. Please be proactive about communicating unmet needs in this regard.

IMF Lab Collaborations

Transdisciplinary collaborations All projects in the IMF Lab involve fostering relationships among academic scientists, resource managers, policy makers, fishery stakeholders, and/or members of the public. In the early stages of project development, we will discuss roles and responsibilities of everyone involved. Approaches to collaboration may be informal (e.g., consisting of semi-regular check-ins) or formal (e.g., involving data use agreements) depending on the nature of the work.

Effective communication A shared understanding of research processes and products is vital to maximizing the utility of your science. **Outreach activities** involve one-way communications, allowing us to share our work with broader audiences. **Community engagement** involves an exchange of information in multiple directions, thereby enhancing the lessons we learn. Common forms of science communication involve creating website content, initiating individual meetings with interested parties, and participating in conferences or roundtable discussions. Regularly presenting your work in writing, at scientific conferences, or at stakeholder meetings will strengthen the quality of your work. Please take care to credit the intellectual (and other) contributions of those who have helped support your work.

Publishing Peer-reviewed publications are the most effective way to ensure that our science is accessible and applicable in the long-term. Publishing also serves as the final product that we identify for funders and helps early career professionals build their credentials as scientists. The peer review process is a vital part of the scientific process because it invariably improves the quality of our work.

I expect all graduate students, postdoctoral scholars, and project leads to publish their research. My philosophy is quality over quantity when publishing, aiming for more complete and impactful “stories” rather than attempting to write as many papers as possible to increase one’s publication record. At least one publishable unit should result from a master’s degree. PhDs should result in at least two or three publications. Postdoctoral scholars and faculty research assistants should expect to publish at least one paper per year. Research conducted by undergraduate students may result in publication, though this is less common given the time required to generate scientific products that meet publication requirements.

Students and postdoctoral scholars typically serve as first author for their research, with myself and other committee members and/or collaborators listed as co-authors. Author order is based on individual contributions to the work (see [CRediT](#) for more information about authorship guidelines). I place considerable emphasis on publishing open access because scientific findings from shared resources should be made available to the public free of charge.

Expectations for Mentees

- 1) Be knowledgeable about and comply with the policies and requirements associated with your position and/or program, [OSU](#), the [Graduate School](#), [CAS](#), [FWCS](#), [COMES](#), and [HMSC](#) (e.g., [here](#)).
- 2) Act according to commonly accepted scientific ethics (click [here](#), [here](#), and [here](#) for more info).
- 3) Read and respond (when appropriate) to all communications from me, committee members, collaborators, OSU, the Graduate School, CAS, FWCS, COMES, and HMSC staff. A confirmation that you received information or a request is appreciated. Please set away messages when responses will be delayed.
- 4) Students may choose to live in Newport, Corvallis, or any of the surrounding areas. It is important, however, that we have sufficient face-to-face interactions. Thus, I expect you to work from the IMF Lab at HMSC at least two (8 hr) days per week when taking classes and three or more (8 hr) days once the bulk of your coursework is complete. Specific days will be identified on a quarterly basis. Adjustments may be made when necessary (e.g., due to course schedules, fieldwork, or my ever-changing schedule). If commuting from Corvallis in winter, please [check road conditions](#) to ensure that it is safe to do so. Click [here](#) for ODOT's winter travel tips.
- 5) Keep the 'IMF Lab' calendar updated with your class schedule, travel dates, etc. Request absences at least two weeks in advance. Students are part-time employees and do not officially accrue paid time off. We can work together to identify potential leave dates, which must accommodate course and/or research needs.
- 6) Maintain clean, organized, and safe (shared) workspaces. Keep personal items within your designated space and ask before hanging items on walls, cabinets, etc.
- 7) Attend all HMSC-based defenses, seminars, and social events (e.g., donut hour) whenever possible.
- 8) Use equipment and supplies purchased by the IMF Lab for their intended purposes only. Return items purchased by the IMF Lab at the completion of your degree or project. Conserving limited resources will maximize the support provided for current and future IMF Lab members.
- 9) Demonstrate commitment to your education by being prepared for and actively engaged in the classroom, meetings, field, and/or lab and maintaining a high level of self-motivation.
- 10) Work with me to develop research questions, identify robust methods, and establish a timeline for project deliverables. Keep me, your committee members, and collaborators updated on your research progress (e.g., via regular project meetings, email briefings, and/or individual conversations).
- 11) Maintain a detailed, organized, and accurate record of your research activities. Take sufficiently detailed notes ([click here](#) for tips) during and/or immediately after meetings. Follow up on all action items in a timely manner.
- 12) Take ownership over your work and discuss details of your data, analyses, and interpretations with relevant experts to solicit feedback and promote sound science. Dedicate sufficient time and energy to research planning and implementation. Independently search for answers by reviewing the scientific literature and relevant websites or asking other students. *You are being trained to serve as the expert on your own research!* That said, please don't spend weeks on a problem that may be resolved by a brief conversation.
- 13) Prioritize the quality of your data and/or analyses. Do not cut corners for the sake of convenience. Likely, your results will be used to inform management practices, which have the potential to impact livelihoods.
- 14) Facilitate your own networking (e.g., be actively engaged in meetings, apply for travel awards and/or volunteer to present at conferences, introduce yourself to others in our field).
- 15) Plan ahead and do your due diligence. This will save time and energy for those involved in your research, increase confidence (in yourself and from others), conserve financial resources, etc.
- 16) Address interpersonal issues in a timely and respectful manner.
- 17) Back up thesis-, dissertation-, and/or manuscript-related files (e.g., data, R scripts, written content) at least once per month. All research-related data are property of OSU and will be retained by the IMF Lab. Final databases and other files must be shared with me before you graduate. Use cloud storage and an external hard drive provided by the IMF Lab to back up all project-related files.
- 18) Allow 2-3 weeks for written reviews. Comments may be possible with shorter turnaround times (e.g., 1-2 weeks) with advanced notice but must be approved by the PI. **Note:** Reviews take time and invariably strengthen the quality and/or communication of your work. Please consider reviewer comments with an open mind and sense of appreciation. Mentees are expected to integrate all reviewer comments, ask clarifying questions to ensure sufficient revisions, and initiate conversations to resolve conflicts when they arise.

- 19) Work with me, your committee members, and collaborators to prepare research products for publication and/or management applications within project deadlines. If the student or postdoctoral scholar cannot meet the timeline agreed upon (extensions are possible, when sufficiently justified) and/or they do not submit for publication within one year of the project's completion, I may be in a position where I need to finalize the manuscript myself – to meet project deliverables, satisfy funding requirements, and/or maintain productive relationships with collaborators. Depending on the amount of work required, this may result in the student or postdoctoral scholar being listed as second author. My expectation, however, is that students and postdoctoral scholars will see their work through to publication. As such, I will provide ample opportunities for the student or postdoctoral scholar to maintain first author status.

Expectations for Mentors

- 1) Be knowledgeable about and comply with the policies and requirements associated with my position and/or program, [OSU](#), the [Graduate School](#), [CAS](#), [FWCS](#), [COMES](#), and [HMSC](#).
- 2) Adhere to commonly accepted scientific ethics (click [here](#), [here](#), and [here](#) for more info).
- 3) Be accessible and thoughtfully respond to all communications within 2-5 business days.
- 4) Provide those under my supervision with an environment that is accessible, equitable, intellectually stimulating, safe, and free from harassment of any kind.
- 5) Direct research projects and other activities within the IMF Lab (e.g., obtain necessary permits, ensure adequate trainings, secure necessary funds, manage budgets, foster collaborations).
- 6) Help mentees set reasonable goals, manage their time, and meet project deliverables. Guide the development of a timeline for degree and/or project completion based on institutional and funding requirements.
- 7) Work with OSU, the Graduate School, CAS, FWCS, COMES, and/or HMSC to ensure that all IMF Lab members can access the resources needed for successful completion of their degree and/or research.
- 8) Meet regularly with students and postdoctoral scholars to ensure that I am knowledgeable about and can provide effective feedback on their academic, research, and professional development.
- 9) Be committed to holistic mentoring, promote individualized professional development opportunities, and effectively train mentees for conducting rigorous scientific research.
- 10) Facilitate development of the complementary skills needed to become a successful fisheries scientist. These may involve oral and written communications, grant writing, database management, the ethical conduct of collaborative research, and discussions about scientific discourse.
- 11) Support, encourage, respect, and foster each mentee's confidence in science by encouraging critical thinking, effective communication, and creativity.
- 12) Review proposal drafts, grant applications, and manuscripts in a timely fashion (i.e., within 1-2 weeks).
- 13) Assist with in the selection of courses and other professional development opportunities that will help mentees meet their short- and long-term career goals.
- 14) Guide mentees in the selection of committee members and/or collaborators, ensuring relevant expertise.
- 15) Prevent potential conflicts of interest from interfering with the success of any mentee's degree, research activities, and/or professional development.
- 16) Help resolve disagreements between or among IMF Lab members, individual committee members, collaborators, and/or coauthors. Manage conflicts should they arise.
- 17) Maintain a high level of curiosity about members of the IMF Lab and their work.
- 18) Help mentees find other mentors when I don't have the necessary expertise.
- 19) Work with the student or postdoctoral scholar to publish their work in a timely manner.
- 20) Acknowledge IMF Lab members for their contributions (to their projects and work that is led by others).
- 21) Provide honest letters of recommendation for scholarships, job applications, and awards.
- 22) Offer career advice and assist in finding a position for the student or postdoctoral scholar following the successful completion of their degree program and/or research.